64 Claude answers to 32 buyer questions in 2 EU niches: who gets linked

We asked Claude 32 questions a buyer would ask about loose-leaf tea and specialty coffee in Belgium and France, twice each. Runs: 2026-10-18 to 2026-10-18. Claude Haiku 4.5 through the Anthropic API with web search on. One engine only.

FINDINGS

- The most-linked shop appears in 31% to 56% of a cell's answers; the top three shops take 17% to 31% of shop links.
- Two runs of the same question share only 45% to 77% of the shop sites they link, on average per cell.
- Links go to shops' own sites: 279 of 326 links.
- Claude linked 1 domain with no working page, 1 time in total, in 1 of 4 cells.

METHOD AND LIMITS

A shop counts as linked when its domain is among the answer's links; names in running text are not counted. Every answer is stored with a timestamp. One engine (claude-haiku-4-5, API, web search on), 64 answers: read percentages as counts, not market share. API answers differ from what a signed-in person sees, and other assistants may link different shops. Domains are as Claude linked them; we checked which ones load on 18 Oct 2026. No causes are claimed. Licence: CC BY 4.0, credit CitedBy with a link.

DATA

Tables per niche and country, method and CSV downloads: citedby.eu/data. Contact: hello@citedby.eu.